

FLOODS

- Eastern zone districts are more prone to extreme floods, followed by northeastern and southern
- But recently, districts in western zone are also witnessing extreme floods, like Rajkot

CYCLONES

- In the past decade, western districts saw a fivefold increase in cyclone events
- Though the frequency is steady, the intensity of these events is becoming more harsh and disastrous

DROUGHTS

- Districts in southern, western and central zones are exposed to both agricultural and meteorological droughts
- There has been a twofold increase in such events across India

THE CLIMATE SWAP

More than 45 per cent of India's districts are witnessing swapping trends—a shifting pattern of extreme events

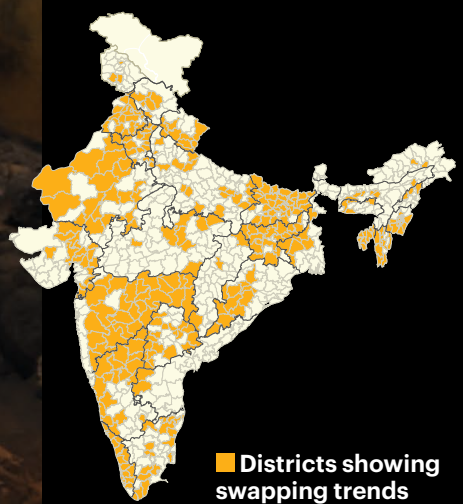
- While some flood-prone areas are now becoming more susceptible to droughts, a few other areas are seeing the exact opposite
- Regions in southern, western and parts of central India are increasingly encountering drought or drought-like situations
- In fact, drought events are becoming more severe across India, which can also be linked to the increase in the number of heat wave days
- Bengaluru, Ahmedabad and Haridwar are among the hotspots showing swapping trends

WHY IT IS HAPPENING

- Major concern in hotspot districts: 55-60% of their landscape changed, natural ecosystem lost
- Unsustainable activities like burning of fossil fuels and transportation
- Tree cover, natural water routes like rivulets, lakes replaced by concrete; coral reefs under stress

WHAT CAN BE DONE

- Restoring, reviving and rehabilitating natural ecosystems like mangroves, wetlands and forests should become a policy imperative
- A detailed risk assessment to help formulate targeted action plans for better preparedness and mitigation
- An Infrastructure Climate Fund for sustained investment into climate-resilient critical infrastructure



Districts showing swapping trends